

A Day in Milan

Milan has some superb cultural and architectural sights, but leave time for a round of clothes-shopping at the many fashion outlets.

MORNING Take a tram or the metro to **Piazza del Duomo** and the fantastic Gothic cathedral. Take the elevator or the winding stairs to its roof terraces for bird's-eye views over the city and north to the Alps. Then stroll through the grandiose **Galleria Vittorio Emanuele II** shopping arcade to reach the world-famous **La Scala** opera house. Continuing in the same direction, you'll reach the **Pinacoteca di Brera**, a cavernous palazzo housing a rich collection of Italian art.

AFTERNOON Head to **Piazza Santa Maria delle Grazie** to gaze on one of the world's masterpieces in a more modest setting – Leonardo da Vinci's *Last Supper* is painted on the walls of the convent's refectory. Relaxing time out can be spent exploring the vast Renaissance brick **Castello Sforzesco** and its adjacent park.

EVENING Wander along the **Navigli canals** and enjoy a drink or meal at the waterside bars and restaurants.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Milan has two **airports**; Malpensa has frequent **trains** and **buses** to the city, while Linate has only a **bus** link. International and domestic **trains** run into Milano Centrale station, to connect with the **metro**, **tram**, and **bus** network.

WHERE TO STAY

Hotel Bernina (inexpensive) is a businesslike hotel that's a bargain and handy for the train station. www.hotelbernina.com

Antica Locanda Leonardo (moderate) is a charming, 19th-century boutique hotel near Santa Maria delle Grazie. www.leoloc.com

Bulgari (expensive) offers stylish modern suites and a relaxing garden. www.bulgarihotels.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

Piazza Castello 1; http://turismo.provincia.milano.it/turismo_en



Right The rice is stirred as it absorbs ladleful after ladleful of stock until just the right consistency is achieved

Below Milan's Duomo is a 14th-century masterpiece of Gothic architecture, built under the reign of the Visconti family

